

news, as well as how to evaluate information sources, where to get credible information, and where to locate fact-checking tools.

Misinformation is rampant

Misinformation, in its most basic meaning, is false or misleading information. When Dictionary.com designated misinformation the 2018 word of the year, it did so alongside a sentence that fits our current situation. Misinformation isn't only inaccurate or misleading information; it's also erroneous information that people distribute without intending to deceive.



Which message is true? Which can you trust?

This new definition takes into account the fact that many people who distribute misinformation online don't realise it's misinformation and aren't doing so maliciously or unethically. Many people spread "fake news" because they find it intriguing and relevant to current events.

Sharing false information, which appears to be a harmless act, can have unanticipated and harmful consequences. Misinformation can become false news if it is reported by news sources or editorial sites without first being fact-checked. Fake news, at its worst, is a threat to democracy. Other topics, such as climate change denial or the anti-vaccination movement, might be fueled by misinformation. Those fighting disinformation are dedicated to ensuring that lies do not harm individuals or society at large.